

THE CRIMSON DAWN

RENEGADE ADEPTUS ASTARTES - FLEET-BASED - RECORDS SEALED

CHAPTER BADGE



Gothic storm-cloud, crimson with white edge. Displayed on the RIGHT shoulder.

COLOUR SWATCHES



Charcoal Black
Primary armour



Deep Crimson
Trim / badge / stripe



Cold Grey
Edge highlights



Dark Gunmetal
Weapons / metal



Lens Red
Eye lenses



Scorched Earth
Basing

CHAPTER DATA

FORMER NAME	The Umbral Wardens
STATUS	Renegade; officially missing / sealed-file
COMMAND	Dawnlord Dolor
FLAGSHIP	Ortus Cruentus ("Bloody Dawn")
BATTLE-CRY	"Pain teaches. Dawn follows."
GENE-SEED	Unknown (Imperial rumours conflict wildly)
COMMAND MARKS	Squad leaders use unique accents/symbols; core black-crimson retained

LORE & DOCTRINE

SUMMARY



Once Loyalist black-ops wardens, they broke with the Imperium after a Mars-seconded recovery detachment reconstructed a forbidden Terran archive and mistook a truncated outcast creed for superior truth. The schism began in that detachment and the cells that answered Dolor - not as a parade-ground mutiny of the entire Chapter at once. They reject God-Emperor worship, deface the Aquila, and wage war to force peace through necessary pain - operating in secret cells they already knew how to run.

To most of the Imperium they barely exist - missing Wardens, sealed files. To Mechanicus and Inquisition hunters they are a need-to-know recovery/purge target. To themselves they are the only ones who listened.

ORIGIN

As Umbral Wardens they were a quiet-war brotherhood: protectors in public, Librarius-heavy kill-cells and sealed-archive work in private. Their fall began not with the whole Chapter, but with a recovery detachment seconded to a Mechanicus quarantine vault on Mars under senior commander Dolor. Those cells recovered a Terran archaeotech data-casket later classed as memetic contraband. The wider Wardens remained on other quiet-war duties.

Librarius reconstruction produced a fragmentary pre-Imperial parable of outcast cadres who sought peace through shared suffering and decisive force. The reading matched wounds those Wardens already carried - Imperial "villages" that farm endless war. Missing verses were treated as redacted intelligence, not as a warning that the creed was incomplete.

Dolor accepted the reconstruction, took a tablet glyph read as "Pain" as his name, and made it law for the detachment. When Mars ordered the casket burned, he refused. The detachment and cells already sworn to him fought free of Sol custody; Wardens who rejected the creed were left behind, killed, or listed among the missing. The breakaways struck the Aquila and became the Crimson Dawn aboard the battle-barge Ortus Cruentus ("Bloody Dawn").

THE INCOMPLETE SCRIPTURE

What survives of the casket is badly truncated and biased toward the outcast cadre. Opposing voices are absent or scrambled. The remaining verses culminate in the annihilation of a fortified settlement - and then stop. There is no restoration, no counter-argument, no aftermath.

The Dawn read that silence as proof: ruin is the completed lesson. They hunt further shards believing the Throne hid the rest. A fragment showing rebuilding, mercy, or the outcasts as villains could split the Chapter - or break Dolor's theology. Until then they act on the ruin already "proven."

CREED, STANDING & WAR

CREED

- Peace bought by ignorance is a lie
- Shared pain ends cycles of war
- Institutions that farm conflict must break
- Settlement-ruin is proof, not tragedy
- The Emperor is rejected as living god
- Skulls honour cost; eagles mark false order
- Completing the scripture is holy work

IMPERIAL STANDING

- Public rolls: missing / records sealed
- Not an open, advertised crusade war
- Mechanicus: quiet recovery or burn order
- Inquisition: need-to-know black warrants
- Sol failure kept politically buried
- Most citizens never hear either name
- Hunters know; sermons do not

STRUCTURE

Codex companies give way to a cell network. Dawnlord Dolor keeps tablet doctrine. Ring-Bearers - Vorago, Ruptura, Nex, Cruor, Fossor, Volumen - lead specialized Cloud Cells (boarding, siege, decapitation, flame purge, shard recovery, Librarius). Two rings stay empty: one lost on Mars, one unfilled until another shard is found. Ash Initiates carry lighter honour marks until proven.

WARFARE

Appear suddenly; overwhelm locally; smash Imperial command icons, shrines, and hive authority; withdraw before a crusade response consolidates. Prefer elite spearheads over grinding occupation. Strategic aim: break a world's will to fight for the Imperium, enforce Dawn law - or vanish, leaving a parable of pain.

They are not Chaos by default, not Loyalists with edgy paint, and not aware their scripture is unfinished fiction. Gene-seed remains unknown; Imperial rumours are loud and usually wrong.



"The casket never should have been opened. It never should have survived. It did both."